Session 4: Automation pipeline and recovery plan

No-Code Automation & Business Pipelines

Your outcome

Build or simulate one intake-to-routing workflow with a clear human approval boundary and a safe response to failure.

Before you begin

Choose a small intake or routing process. Use a test workspace and fictional submissions; identify any action that would send a message or alter real records.

Participant details

Name: _____ Cohort: _____
Project / task: _____

Working boundaries

Use fictional or explicitly approved examples. Do not paste private customer, employee, health or financial records into public AI tools. Follow your organization's tool and data rules. Treat outputs as drafts; a person verifies facts and approves external actions.

What to keep

Keep a copy of your inputs, outputs, decisions and revisions. Browser-only drafts may not follow you to another device. Upload the completed resource or share a permitted link through your participant dashboard.

Course coaching

Each cohort participant may request one remote coaching session during the course. Request it inside the platform; your instructor confirms the time. Use the same conversation for time changes.

Lab guide

Follow your instructor or work through these steps using approved tools. A document or manual simulation is acceptable when a connected tool is unavailable; label its status honestly.

Step 1

Plan the smallest pipeline: trigger → input checks → draft → human approval → action → destination verification. Agree on expected outputs before connecting tools.

Step 2

Use a test workspace or a manual simulation. Add checks for missing fields, unsupported claims, and duplicate inputs; block the action until a human approves the exact draft.

Step 3

Test a valid request, an invalid request, a duplicate, and a partial failure. Compare the destination records with the intended actions before retrying anything.

Worked example — fictional / illustrative

Fictional example: a form creates one sandbox lead row and drafts an acknowledgement. A person approves the exact text before any send. Replaying the same request must not create a second lead. A manual simulation is acceptable when tool access is unavailable; label it honestly.

Try the prompt sheet

Use the companion prompt sheet as a starting point, replace bracketed fields and test the result. It is not a guarantee of accuracy or an instruction to publish anything.

Participant worksheet

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Workflow owner / test, simulation or pilot status

_____
_____

Trigger / required fields / destination

_____
_____

Input validation and duplicate identifier

_____
_____

Trigger -> checks -> draft -> approval -> action -> verification

_____
_____

Tool connections and minimum permissions

_____
_____

Participant worksheet — continued

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Human approval point and approved version

_____

_____

Four test cases: expected / actual / evidence

_____

_____

Pause procedure / failed-step recovery / safe retry

_____

_____

Handoff owner / approval required before live use

_____

_____

Test, challenge and improve

Test 1

Valid: a fictional intake contains all required fields; create the intended test record and a draft response.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 2

Invalid or duplicate: required email is missing, or the same test request arrives twice. Route to review or identify the existing record.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 3

Partial failure: the record is created but the response step fails. Identify the completed step before retrying so you do not create duplicate records or messages.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Transfer challenge

Give a peer your recovery instructions. Can they identify what already happened and resume safely without your explanation? Record one improvement.

Review and submit

Mark each criterion ready, needs revision, or not applicable with a reason. An instructor reviews the evidence; completing a worksheet alone does not establish approval or certificate eligibility.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — Trigger, destinations, and a workflow owner are documented.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — Valid, invalid, and duplicate inputs have test evidence.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — External actions have explicit approval boundaries.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — A pause/rollback procedure and failure route exist.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — The hand-off states whether this is a test, pilot, or approved deployment.

Submission

Submit under Operational Trigger Pipeline in My work. Include your artifact or permitted link, test evidence and notes about what changed. Save a draft if it is not ready for review.

Feedback and follow-through

Feedback received: _____
Change I made: _____
Evidence retested: _____
My next action / owner / review point: _____